

Here is **the arc ACB** , a piece of curve fixed in position, rising from the point of contact A up through C to a nearby point B . The phrase *continuous curvature* means the curve bends *smoothly* — at every point, including A , it has one definite direction and no sharp corner. This smoothness is Newton's standing assumption, the supposition he will not let go of. **This arc** is the object whose ultimate behaviour near A we mean to investigate.